Investec × STUF SET THEM UP FOUNDATION

MONEY MATTERS ACADEMY IMPACT REPORT 2025

INVESTEC X SET THEM UP FOUNDATION (STUF)

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

01.

In July 2025, Investec partnered with Set Them Up Foundation (STUF) to deliver the Money Matters Academy to 20 young people from Newham College in East London.

02.

The programme combined structured financial education with skills-based employee volunteering, engaging 10 Investec volunteers to support two interactive 120-minute workshops hosted at Investec's London office.

03.

The initiative aimed to:

- Improve financial literacy & applied money management skills.
- Increase confidence in budgeting and saving.
- Strengthen long-term financial planning capability.
- Support young people from low socio-economic backgrounds.
- Provide meaningful employee volunteering opportunities.

04.

Baseline findings identified gaps in budgeting confidence, financial wellbeing, and behavioural consistency. Post-programme results demonstrate significant improvements in financial capability, confidence, and behavioural intention.

05.

The partnership reflects Investec's commitment to societal impact and financial inclusion and aligns with the Business for Societal Impact (B4SI) Community Investment framework.

CONTEXT & NEED

Financial education is increasingly critical for young people across London.



Nearly half of young people aged 16-25 report that the cost-of-living crisis has had a greater impact on their lives than the pandemic



Many leave formal education without practical skills in budgeting, saving, credit management, or long-term financial planning.



Financial capability is not simply an educational issue - it is a social mobility issue.



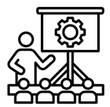
Corporate institutions, particularly within financial services, have a critical role in equipping young people with practical financial knowledge and confidence to support long-term independence and resilience.

In boroughs such as Newham:

- Youth poverty rates are above the national average
- Household incomes are lower than the London average
- Rental costs are among the highest in the UK
- Financial vulnerability disproportionately affects young people

PROGRAMME OVERVIEW - MONEY MATTERS ACADEMY

01



DELIVERY MODEL

- Two 120-minute workshops
- Delivered at Investec's London office
- 20 students
- 10 Investec employee volunteers
- £10,000 programme investment

02



CORE FOCUS AREAS

- Budgeting and money management
- Saving strategies and financial goal setting
- Credit awareness and responsible borrowing
- Long-term planning (renting, mortgages, deposits, pensions)
- Risk and return fundamentals

The programme combined structured content with real-world discussion, supported by Investec volunteers sharing professional & personal insight.

BASELINE FINDINGS (PRE-PROGRAMME)

Prior to participating in the Money Matters Academy, all 20 students completed a structured pre-programme survey designed to assess their financial knowledge, confidence, behaviours, and overall financial wellbeing. The purpose of this baseline assessment was to establish a clear starting point, identify key capability gaps, and enable measurable comparison following programme delivery. The findings below reflect the initial financial literacy levels and self-reported confidence of participants before engaging in the workshops.

Participants demonstrated foundational financial awareness but lacked consistent confidence, behavioural application, and financial satisfaction-highlighting a clear need for intervention.

Financial Knowledge

- 56% average correct response rate across 8 technical financial literacy questions
- Strong understanding of inflation and basic interest
- Lower accuracy in long-term compounding and investment suitability

Financial Confidence

- 45% reported low confidence in budgeting
- 40% reported low confidence in overall financial knowledge
- Only 40% reported high budgeting confidence

Financial Behaviours

Positive financial behaviour indicators ranged between 55%-70%

- 70% compare prices before purchasing
- 60% ensure savings before major purchases
- 55% prioritise repaying borrowed money

Financial Wellbeing

- 55% dissatisfied with their current financial situation
- 35% satisfied
- 10% neutral

POST-PROGRAMME OUTCOMES (YOUNG PEOPLE)



POST-PROGRAMME OUTCOMES

Participants: **20**

Following completion of the Money Matters Academy, post-programme survey results demonstrate significant improvements in financial capability, confidence, and behavioural intention.

BUDGETING

- **100%** understand how to create an effective budget plan
- **95%** intend to create a budget as a result of the sessions

Participants moved from mixed baseline confidence to universal understanding and clear behavioural intention.

SAVING & FINANCIAL PLANNING

- **30%** currently have a savings account
- **70%** intend to open a savings account following the programme
- **75%** feel confident saving for long-term goals
- **75%** know the practical Steps required to achieve saving goals

The programme successfully translated awareness into practical clarity and action.

COMMUNITY RIPPLE EFFECT

- **95%** will share their learning with friends and family

This suggests potential for wider community financial knowledge transfer beyond the **20** direct participants.

PRE VS POST IMPACT NARRATIVE

From Awareness to Action – Baseline Position

Pre-programme findings highlighted clear areas of need among participants:

- 45% reported low confidence in budgeting
- 55% expressed dissatisfaction with their current financial situation
- Financial behaviours were inconsistent, particularly around saving and borrowing practices

These findings demonstrated that while foundational knowledge existed, practical confidence and applied financial capability required strengthening.

Post-Programme Outcomes

Following completion of the Money Matters Academy, results show significant positive shifts:

- 100% understand how to create an effective budget plan
- 95% intend to implement budgeting practices
- 75% feel confident saving for long-term goals
- 75% understand the practical steps required to achieve saving goals

Impact Insight

The programme successfully moved participants from awareness to action.

Students progressed from mixed confidence levels and financial dissatisfaction to demonstrable capability, clarity, and behavioural intent. This shift represents a meaningful step toward improved financial resilience, stronger decision-making, and greater long-term Independence.



Budgeting confidence
Pre workshops

45%



Budgeting confidence
Post workshops

100%



Intend to implement budgeting practices

95%



Feel confident saving for long-term goals

75%



Understand steps required to achieve saving goals

75%

EMPLOYEE VOLUNTEER IMPACT

Employee Engagement & Development – 10 Investec Volunteers

Overall Experience

- 80% rated experience as Excellent
- 90% felt very well prepared
- 80% found the content very engaging

Perceived Impact

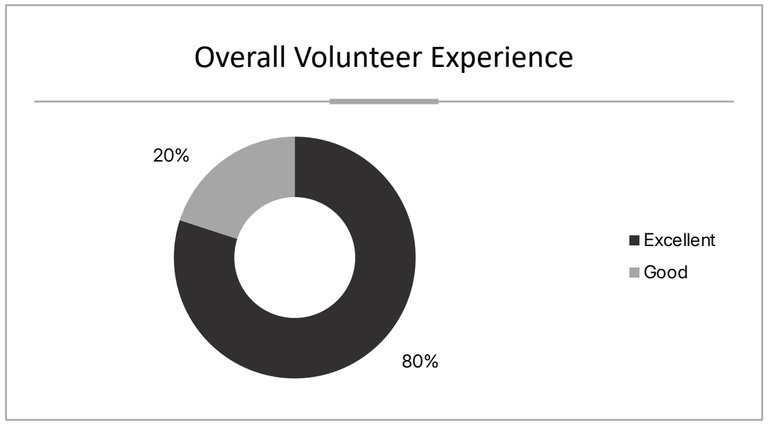
- 80% felt they made a significant impact
- 90% rated young people as very engaged
- 90% believe the programme definitely improves financial literacy

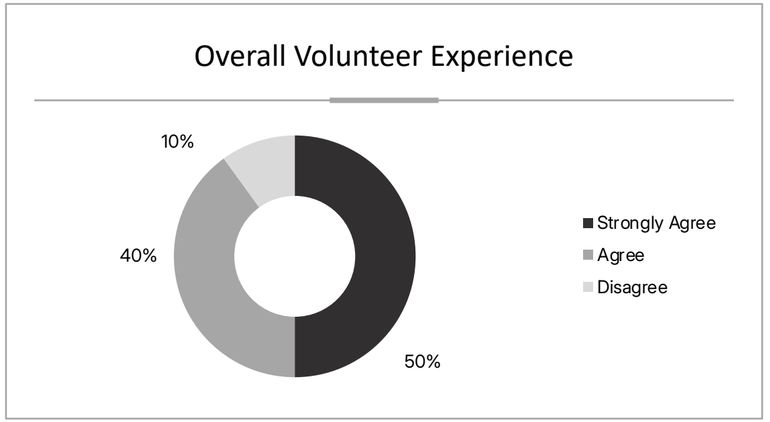
Awareness & Development

- 100% gained new perspectives
- 90% more confident engaging with young people
- 70% increased sense of purpose at work
- 90% more likely to volunteer again
- 100% would recommend the programme

Volunteer Impact Insight

The programme delivered meaningful employee engagement, strengthened awareness of financial inequality, and supported communication and coaching skill development.





IMPACT IN THEIR OWN WORDS

Start saving early and stick to categories which are reliable

Student Newham College

Saving early has a big prize at the end

Student Morpeth School

I've learn that it is better to save money Invest rather than just spening it In the moment

Student Morpeth School

I've learned how switched on our young people are about Investing. Amazing

Investec Volunteer

Invest Early, Brighter future

Student Newham college

After today, I am going to look into Investing and start very soon

Student Newhom College



One thing I leant today is that the earlier you start Investing the better. Compound Interest

Student Morpeth School

Very Informative for the young people who im sure will use this and set goals

Investec Volunteer

I have learnt how to Invest safely

Student Morpeth School

I've learnt that it is better to save money rather than just spending it in the moment

Student Newhom college

Learnt how little i knew about this stuff when I was younger

Investec Volunteer

They need to teach this in schools so all children can learn how to manage thier finance

Student Newham College

B4SI COMMUNITY INVESTMENT ALIGNMENT

INPUTS

- Programme investment
- 10 employee volunteers
- 4 hours structured delivery
- In-kind office space & catering

OUTPUTS

- 20 young people engaged
- 2 workshops delivered
- 10 employees activated
- Monitoring and evaluation completed

OUTCOMES – YOUNG PEOPLE

- 100% budgeting understanding
- 75% saving confidence
- 70% savings account intention
- 95% knowledge-sharing intention

OUTCOMES – EMPLOYEES

- 80% excellent experience
- 70% increased sense of purpose
- 90% future volunteering intention

This partnership demonstrates:

- Measurable community impact
- High-quality employee engagement
- Alignment with financial inclusion objectives
- Contribution to social mobility in London
- Clear reporting aligned to Basi community investment standards

THE PROGRAMME PROVIDES A SCALABLE MODEL FOR FUTURE CORPORATE-SUPPORTED FINANCIAL CAPABILITY INITIATIVES.

CONCLUSION

The Investec x STUF Money Matters Academy has delivered measurable short-term impact and strong indicators of sustained financial capability development.

Young people moved from mixed confidence levels and financial dissatisfaction to universal budgeting understanding, increased saving confidence, and clear behavioural intention.

Simultaneously, Investec employees reported enhanced purpose, increased awareness of financial inequality, and strengthened communication and coaching skills.

Through combining corporate investment, employee engagement, and targeted financial education delivery, this initiative demonstratesa powerful and measurable contribution to youth financial resilience and societal impact.



